

UNIVERSITY OF ESSEX

Undergraduate Examinations 2022

CURRENT DISPUTES IN SOCIOLOGY: SOCIOLOGICAL ANALYSIS III

Time allowed: 24 hours

Please see your exam timetable or check on FASER for the deadline to upload your answer.

The times shown on your timetable are in British Summer Time (BST). Please check online for a conversion to your local time if you will be undertaking your assessment outside the United Kingdom.

INSTRUCTIONS

Candidates must answer **THREE** questions: **ONE** from **SECTION A**, **ONE** from **SECTION B** and **ONE** from either **SECTION A** or **SECTION B**.

Candidates must answer **THREE** questions in total.

The paper consists of **SEVENTEEN** questions in total.

All questions are of equal weight.

You may write up to 2250 words for this paper, a suggested 750 per question.

These questions have been set so that you can answer them within the normal exam time frame which is three hours. You are not expected to spend 24 hours on this assessment.

Referencing and plagiarism

You may consult resources for this take-home exam. You are NOT expected to provide a bibliography.

You must avoid copying from text books, articles, online sources or your own previous work. If you do quote, you must use quotation marks and provide in-text references. Penalties for plagiarism will apply.

You are reminded that collaborating with other students is collusion, which is also an academic offence. Penalties will apply.

Submission

If you have a query with the content of this exam paper contact socugrad@essex.ac.uk

If you have a technical problem with FASER, or any other query, please go to [Exams Website](#) to find contact details of the teams that can help you.

Please note that the time allocated for this assessment includes time for you to download this question and answer paper and to upload your question and answers paper to FASER.

Please allow at least 30 minutes at the end of your exam time to upload your work. Once you have completed the assessment do not leave it to the last minute to upload.

Please save your work throughout the examination to avoid losing your work. **You must only submit Microsoft Word documents.**

Please do not communicate with any other candidate in any way during this assessment. Your response must be your own work. Procedures are in place to detect plagiarism and collusion.

Candidates must answer **THREE** questions: **ONE** from **SECTION A**, **ONE** from **SECTION B** and **ONE** from either **SECTION A** or **SECTION B**.

SECTION A

1. Is Sociology a science? If so, what kind of science is it?
2. How have the ideas of neo-Kantians influenced sociology?
3. Is modernity undermined by its roots in colonialism?
4. Can language create inequality?
5. Critically assess Barthes' argument that popular culture is "mythological".
6. How useful is Bourdieu's concept of cultural capital for understanding contemporary social inequality.
7. Why and how should sociologists analyse inequalities in global wealth?
8. Should women's experience be the basis of feminism?
9. Does feminist epistemology reject the concept of objectivity?

END OF SECTION A

Candidates must answer **THREE** questions: **ONE** from **SECTION A**, **ONE** from **SECTION B** and **ONE** from either **SECTION A** or **SECTION B**.

SECTION B

10. Foucault described the power inherent in contemporary society as “disciplinary”. What did he mean by this? How useful do you find this term?
11. How useful is Foucault’s notion of biopower for understanding contemporary society.
12. Drawing from at least two of the following authors – Du Bois, Toni Morrison, Paul Gilroy – discuss the implications of the concept of “race” for understanding contemporary society.
13. How does the concept of “the West” set itself up in distinction to “the Rest”?
14. Critically examine the links between vision, power and knowledge?
15. Why is it important to examine social theory which emerges from beyond the West?
16. How can sociologists contribute to an understanding of the climate crisis?
17. What are the implications of treating the concepts of “sex” and gender as binary?

END OF SECTION B

END OF PAPER

PLEASE SEE NEXT PAGE FOR THE ANSWER SHEET

ANSWER SHEET
(Please use as many sheets as you need to)

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Student Registration Number:

TYPE THE QUESTION NUMBERS AND YOUR ANSWERS HERE: